



intention of doing so in the future. Our economy is open. We hope that, in the end, all violations of World Trade Organization regulations will be rectified.

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GM: Are we looking at alternative payment systems? Is there going to be a BRICS currency?

There's no rush in this, *festina lente* (make haste slowly) and you'll avoid big mistakes. For instance, in Europe, they set up the Euro system and dragged in certain countries that weren't economically ready for one single strong currency. And now they're dealing with some difficult social matters. There's more than just playing

around with inflation there, right? This question is far more complex than just tinkering with inflation a little bit and calling it done. Their entire economy is tied to just one stable currency, therefore social problems arise and budgetary issues emerge. Right now, we don't aim to have a single currency within BRICS. In this process, there's no rush anywhere. There is a need to expand the use of national currencies. We must make better use of the BRICS New Development Bank's opportunities. For example, we propose creating a new investment platform using electronic payments (with an initial capital of \$100 billion) to encourage joint

investments both in our economies and those of developing nations in the Global South. This could be a very appealing option, because these investments would help us, and they would also benefit the recipient countries, since together we would produce high quality goods at reasonable prices. These products could help the countries of the South to develop further, while also advancing our own growth.

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GM: Rupee and ruble payment then?

There are no obstacles here. These are purely economic issues. We fully understand and realise that we do have a

certain trade imbalance. However, India's government does not impose restrictions on our mutual trade. Why? Because they need both oil and petroleum products. The Indian government needs to expand its purchases of Russian fertilisers because these are crucial for Indian farmers. The issue is completely different. It's not about rupees; it's about what those rupees can buy for our companies. We're also thinking about this, not only the Indian government, but we also do. And we agree that this disparity must be addressed, but not through bans, rather by finding areas beneficial for both sides. I want to share with you something completely candidly: this was my direct instruction to the Government of Russia, which is to consider what else we could purchase from India.

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AOK: AI is a force to reckon with. Is it for chaos or good?

Like any other achievement, it can be both good and evil. Those who will be the first to master this technology, use it most effectively, would gain a tremendous benefit in all spheres because that will have a multiplier effect for efficiency and productivity. There are also challenges here. And, naturally, we need to take steps to guarantee safety and protection. **BT**